

The Ethical Hacker's Command Handbook

Chapter 3 – Part 1: Searchsploit Fundamentals & Exploit Research

Enumeration tells you what exists. Research tells you what is known about it.

Learning Objectives

Understand Searchsploit, Exploit-DB, basic searches, version-specific research, CVE lookups, result interpretation, and responsible vulnerability research workflows.

What is Searchsploit?

Searchsploit is a command-line tool that searches a locally stored copy of Exploit-DB. It helps locate public exploit references for identified software. It does not scan or exploit targets.

What is Exploit-DB?

Exploit-DB is a public archive of exploit references, proof-of-concept code, and related information. Entries typically include a title, EDB-ID, platform, file path, and references.

searchsploit apache

Purpose: Search software

What it does: Find exploit references related to Apache.

When to use: After identifying Apache with Nmap.

Avoid when: Software is still unknown.

Memory Tip: Search software first.

searchsploit "Apache 2.4.49"

Purpose: Search by version

What it does: Narrow results using product and version.

When to use: Exact version identified.

Avoid when: Version unknown.

Memory Tip: Version = Better results.

searchsploit windows

Purpose: Search by operating system

What it does: Locate Windows-related entries.

When to use: After OS detection.

Avoid when: Searching for a specific application.

Memory Tip: OS-level research.

searchsploit samba

Purpose: Search by service

What it does: Research a detected service.

When to use: Service identified during enumeration.

Avoid when: Service not confirmed.

Memory Tip: One service at a time.

searchsploit CVE-2021-41773

Purpose: Search by CVE

What it does: Locate entries matching a known CVE.

When to use: You already know the CVE identifier.

Avoid when: CVE is unknown.

Memory Tip: CVE = Specific vulnerability.

Typical Workflow

Nmap Enumeration → Identify Software → Identify Version → Searchsploit → Review Exploit References → Verify Applicability → Document Findings

Reference Fields

Field	Meaning
Title	Exploit description
EDB-ID	Exploit-DB identifier
Platform	Target platform
Path	Local exploit file location

Practice Questions

1. What is Searchsploit?
2. How is Searchsploit different from Nmap?
3. Why search using software versions?
4. What does an EDB-ID represent?
5. Why should exploit references always be verified before drawing conclusions?